

Competition Agenda - Day One

Friday, November 7, 2025
8:45 a.m. – 5:00 p.m. PT
Middlebury Institute of
International Studies at Monterey
#Cyber912
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- 8:45 – 9:15 a.m.** **Breakfast Served & Registration (McCone Atrium)**
- 9:15 – 9:30 a.m.** **Welcoming Remarks (Irvine Auditorium, McCone Building, 499 Pierce St)**
Safa Shahwan Edwards, *Director, Capacity Building & Communities, Cyber Statecraft Initiative, Atlantic Council*
- Philipp Bleek**, *Professor and Co-Coordinator, Cyber Collaborative, Middlebury Institute of International Studies at Monterey*
- 9:30 – 10:00 a.m.** **Keynote Address: The Evolution of US Cyber Strategy (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)**
Jacquelyn Schneider, *Hargrove Hoover Fellow, Director, Hoover Wargaming and Crisis Simulation Initiative, Hoover Institution*
- 10:00 – 10:20 a.m.** **Competitors' Briefing (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)**
Urmita Chowdhury, *Assistant Director, Cyber Statecraft Initiative, Atlantic Council*
- Safa Shahwan Edwards**, *Director, Capacity Building & Communities, Cyber Statecraft Initiative, Atlantic Council*
- 10:00 – 10:20 a.m.** **Judges' Briefing (McCone 238)**
Morgan McMurray, *Associate Director, Cyber Statecraft Initiative, Atlantic Council*
- Jake Lopata**, *Graduate Assistant, Middlebury Institute of International Studies at Monterey*
- 10:30 – 12:00 p.m.** **Morning Qualifying Rounds (McGowan 100, McGowan 102, Morse B104, Morse B105, Center for the Blue Economy Room 1 and 2)**
Wave 1 10:30 - 11:10 a.m. | Wave 2 11:20 – 12:00 p.m.
- 12:00 – 1:00 p.m.** **Lunch Served (Taco Truck on Pierce Street)**

- 1:00 – 2:00 p.m.** **Panel Discussion: Emerging National Security Threats Across Sectors (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)**
Jeffrey Lewis, Director, CNS East Asia Nonproliferation Program, Middlebury Institute of International Studies at Monterey

Cervando Bañuelos II, Senior Product Security Engineer, Aurora

Melissa Oh, Managing Director, TGY Advisors LLC

Pavan Gill, Regional Director of the Pacific Region, Defense Innovation Unit

Moderated by:
Habiba Mickdad, Cyber Collaborative Student Lead, Middlebury Institute of International Studies at Monterey
- 2:00 – 2:15 p.m.** **[Optional] Afternoon Judges' Briefing (McCone 238)**
Morgan McMurray, Associate Director, Cyber Statecraft Initiative, Atlantic Council
- 2:30 – 4:00 p.m.** **Afternoon Qualifying Rounds (McGowan100, McGowan102, Morse B104, Morse B105, Center for the Blue Economy (CBE) Room 1 and 2)**
Wave 3 2:30 – 3:10 p.m. | Wave 4 3:20 – 4:00 p.m.
- 4:00 – 4:30 p.m.** **BREAK**
- 4:30 – 4:45 p.m.** **Individual Awards Ceremony (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)**
Morgan McMurray, Associate Director, Cyber Statecraft Initiative, Atlantic Council

Philipp Bleek, Professor and Co-Coordinator, Cyber Collaborative, Middlebury Institute of International Studies at Monterey
- 4:45 – 5:00 p.m.** **Announcement of Semi-Finalists (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)**
Safa Shahwan Edwards, Director, Capacity Building & Communities, Cyber Statecraft Initiative, Atlantic Council
- 5:30 – 7:00 p.m.** **Evening Social (Samson Center, 453 Van Buren St)**
Jeff Dayton-Johnson, Dean of the Institute and VP for Academic Affairs, Middlebury Institute of International Studies at Monterey
- 6:30 p.m.** **Release of Intelligence Report II**

Competition Agenda - Day Two

Saturday, November 8, 2025
8:45 a.m. – 5:00 p.m. PT
Middlebury Institute of
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- 8:45 - 9:00 a.m.** **Breakfast Served & Registration (McCone Atrium)**
- 9:00 - 9:30 a.m.** **Keynote Address: North Korea Is Just a Cyber Criminal Organization Pretending to Be a Nation State (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)**
Allan Liska, *Threat Intelligence Researcher*, Recorded Future
- Introduction by:
Karen Nershi, *Professor and Director, Cyber Collaborative*, Middlebury Institute of International Studies at Monterey
- 9:30 - 9:50 a.m.** **Competitor Open Q&A Time (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)**
Urmita Chowdhury, *Assistant Director, Cyber Statecraft Initiative*, Atlantic Council
- Safa Shahwan Edwards**, *Director, Capacity Building & Communities, Cyber Statecraft Initiative*, Atlantic Council
- 9:30 - 9:50 a.m.** **Judges' Briefing (McCone 238)**
Morgan McMurray, *Associate Director, Cyber Statecraft Initiative*, Atlantic Council
- Jake Lopata**, *Graduate Assistant*, Middlebury Institute of International Studies at Monterey
- 10:00 – 11:30 a.m.** **Semi-Final Rounds (McGowan100, McGowan102, Morse B104, Morse B105, Center for the Blue Economy (CBE) Room 1 and 2)**
Wave 1 10:00 – 10:40 a.m. | Wave 2 10:50 – 11:30 a.m.
- 11:30 – 12:00 p.m.** **Lunch Served (Samson Center, 453 Van Buren St)**
- 12:00 – 2:00 p.m.** **Side Event: Analytical Tradecraft Workshop (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)**
James Plotts, U.S. Department of State/Central Intelligence Agency (Ret.)
- 2:00 – 2:20 p.m.** **Announcement of Finalists & Introduction of Final Round Judges (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)**
Safa Shahwan Edwards, *Director, Capacity Building & Communities, Cyber Statecraft Initiative*, Atlantic Council
- 2:30 – 4:30 p.m.** **Final Round (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)**

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Casey Ellis, *Founder*, Bugcrowd

Kimberly Kearney, *Founder*, INICIO Executive Consulting

Ulf Lindqvist, *Senior Technical Director*, SRI International

Pavan Gill, *Regional Director of the Pacific Region*, Defense Innovation Unit

Karen Nershi, *Professor and Director, Cyber Collaborative*, Middlebury Institute of International Studies at Monterey

4:45 – 5:00 p.m.

Announcement of Awards and Closing Ceremony (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)

Safa Shahwan Edwards, *Director, Capacity Building & Communities, Cyber Statecraft Initiative*, Atlantic Council

Karen Nershi, *Professor and Director, Cyber Collaborative*, Middlebury Institute of International Studies at Monterey